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iPhone SE (2022)

Powerful package at a good price

The iPhone SE (2022) is Apple's latest affordable flagship. The phone not only replaces the previous iPhone SE but also takes on the might of some popular Android devices from the high-end segment. Is the device worth spending your money on? Let's find out.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Let's start with what's arguably the most boring bit about the iPhone SE (2022) – its design. The phone offers the same design language that we first saw on the iPhone 8. It's compact and lightweight. We have a dated design language with chunky bezels on the front and also a mechanical home button that also hides the company's TouchID tech underneath. But to the company's credit, it has machined the iPhone SE (2022) for great ergonomics.

DISPLAY

The iPhone SE (2022) flaunts a rather compact, 4.7-inch IPS LCD panel. However, that's exactly the last good thing about this display. For a high-end segment phone launched in 2022, not only is this panel too small, but it also doesn't cut it in terms of quality that you'd come to expect from a phone from the segment. It's also not a fast refresh rate panel and runs at 60Hz.

The display on the phone in our tests managed to hit a peak typical brightness of 472 nits. While this does not make it the brightest in the segment, we found it to be plenty bright for most use case scenarios. The display is also well-calibrated and offers good colour accuracy levels as well.

PERFORMANCE

The iPhone SE (2022) also offers a lot when it comes to performance. As a device that gets Apple's new A15 Bionic SoC, we also get some serious upgrades with the iPhone SE (2022) over its predecessor, and more importantly, its



Price
₹43,900

biggest competitor, Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 1 SoC.

As such, the performance on the device is in some cases even better than what you get on some flagship Android phones. In benchmarks as well, the performance was in line with what we've seen on the iPhone 13 and iPhone 13 Pro. Gaming performance too, was generally pretty good, with games running like a charm on the device.

Our performance testing also saw us examine the battery performance of the iPhone SE (2022). Here the results were as expected, with the device proving to be one of the better performing devices in the department in the segment. In our time with it, we managed to get over a day's work on moderate usage. The iPhone SE (2022) also gets support for 20W fast wired charging, which helps it go from 0-50 per cent around 30 minutes.

CAMERAS

The camera system on this affordable iPhone is as basic as basic gets. However, that does not mean it's not good. In fact, it's still a good point-and-shoot

camera for most users. At the heart of the set-up is a single 12-megapixel wide-angle lens at the back, and there's also a 7-megapixel wide-angle lens at the front for clicking selfies.

Pictures clicked using the iPhone SE (2022) come out with a good amount of detail, however, they don't look as rich and punchy as the ones clicked using the other current-gen iPhones. Low light performance, however, is a different story altogether, with the rear lens leaving a little to be desired from its performance. Its frailties are exposed when fed with an inadequate amount of light, as it fails to capture enough amount of detail.

The selfie lens captures a good amount of detail and accurate colour tones. There's no oversharpening of textures as well. However, the low light performance of this lens as well is not always up to the mark.



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VERDICT

The iPhone SE (2022) offers a lot to like if you're a fan of compact form factor smartphones. It is a phone that promises you good battery life, and also brings with it the promise of powerful performance for pretty much anything

you do on the device. To top it off, it also offers a pretty good point-and-shoot camera experience with its single-lens camera set-up at the back. However, it may still not be the phone for everyone. And the reasons are obvious. The lack of a bigger display, the outdated design, and average low-light camera performance are reasons to ignore the iPhone SE (2022) in favour of an Android.

—Sushant Talwar

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 4.7-inches, Retina IPS LCD, 750 x 1334 pixels | WEIGHT: 144g | SOC: Apple A15 Bionic | RAM: 4 GB | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 64/128/256 GB | OS: iOS 15.4, upgradable to iOS 15.4.1 | REAR CAMERA: 12 MP, f/1.8 | REAR CAMERA VIDEO: 4K@24/30/60fps, 1080p@30/60/120/240fps | FRONT CAMERA: 7 MP | BATTERY AND CHARGING: 2,018 mAh, 20 W fast charging, 7.5 W wireless charging

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